Home, my day & finding your way

Look → listen → cover → recall → write → type

Classroom material: 4 November 2026. Home, renting, routine, buildings and directions.

At home

家

Renting & getting around

坐 / 做 / 座

My day

先 → 再

Find your bearings

北 · 东 · 南 · 西

Around the campus

A 在 B 的……边

Give directions

往前走 · 左转 · 右转

Rain, money & similar sounds

钱 qián · 千 qiān · 前 qián

Choose how to travel

走 · 骑 · 坐 · 开 · 打 / 叫 · 租

Original class sentences are retained; related examples are marked. Textbook maps are redrawn as teaching diagrams. Pinyin displays 一/不 tone changes in phrases; the syllable 边 is neutral here.

Where is the building?



Teaching diagram. North is always up. East is right. The front dormitory row is nearer the school.

银行在书店东边。
Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

书店在银行西边。
Shūdiàn zài yínháng xībian.

宿舍楼都在北边。
Sùshè lóu dōu zài běibian.

Change your viewpoint

Left and right depend on which way you face. North and south do not change.

Facing north

东边 → 右边
dōngbian → yòubian

西边 → 左边
xībian → zuǒbian

北边 → 前边
běibian → qiánbian

南边 → 后边
nánbian → hòubian

Facing south

东边 → 左边
dōngbian → zuǒbian

西边 → 右边
xībian → yòubian

北边 → 后边
běibian → hòubian

南边 → 前边
nánbian → qiánbian

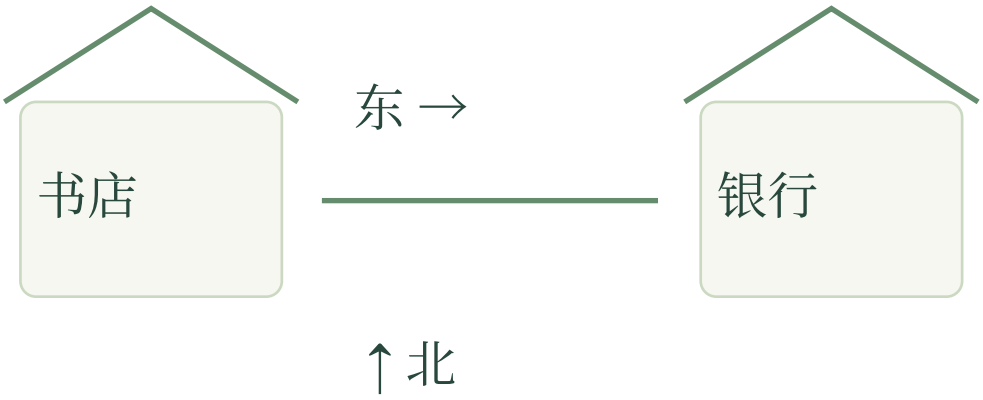
Memory cue: 东西 means east–west, but dōngxi also means “things”. The compass directions have a stable map reference; left/right use the person’s orientation.

A 在 B 的……边。

Name A, choose reference B, then add the direction. The 的 is often omitted: 银行在书店东边。

Build a location sentence

Keep the buildings fixed. Change which building you describe.



A: locate	在	B: reference	Position
银行 yínháng	在 zài	书店 shūdiàn	东边 dōngbian

A: locate	在	B: reference	Position
书店 shūdiàn	在 zài	银行 yínháng	西边 xībian

书店东边 = 书店的东边

Both mean east of the bookshop. 的 is often optional here.

Twelve ways to travel



走路

zǒu lù

walk; go on foot



骑自行车

qí zìxíngchē

ride a bicycle

E



骑电动车

qí diàndòngchē

ride an e-bike



坐公交车

zuò gōngjiāochē

take the bus



坐地铁

zuò dìtiě

take the metro



坐出租车

zuò chūzūchē

take a taxi



开车

kāi chē

drive a car

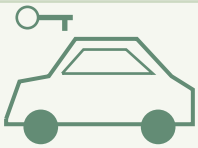
APP



叫网约车

jiào wǎngyuēchē

book an app-based ride



租车

zū chē

rent a car



坐火车

zuò huǒchē

take the train



坐高铁

zuò gāotiě

take a high-speed train



坐飞机

zuò fēijī

take a plane; fly

Which verb matches the action?

走	走路 Walk on foot
骑	骑自行车 / 骑电动车 Ride a bicycle / e-bike
坐	坐地铁 / 坐出租车 Travel as a passenger
开	开车 Drive the car yourself
打 / 叫	打车 / 打的 / 叫网约车 Hail / call a taxi or ride
租	租车 Rent a car; not the same as taking a taxi

我想打车，不想租车。

Wǒ xiǎng dǎ chē, bù xiǎng zū chē.

Read in meaning groups

我 有 一套公寓。

Wǒ yǒu yí tào gōngyù.

I have an apartment.

我的公寓里 有 两个卧室。

Wǒ de gōngyù lǐ yǒu liǎng ge wòshì.

There are two bedrooms in my apartment.

还有 一个厨房、 一个卫生间 和一个客厅。

Hái yǒu yí ge chúfáng, yí ge wèishēngjiān hé yí ge kètīng.

There is also a kitchen, a bathroom and a living room.

我的房间里 有 一张床、 一张桌子 和两把椅子。

Wǒ de fángjiān lǐ yǒu yì zhāng chuáng, yì zhāng zhuōzi hé liǎng bǎ yǐzi.

My room has a bed, a desk and two chairs.

你 想租房 吗?

Nǐ xiǎng zū fáng ma?

Do you want to rent a place?

Read in meaning groups

我 要租房， 不是租车。

Wǒ yào zū fáng, bú shì zū chē.

I want to rent a home, not a car.

我 想 坐出租车。

Wǒ xiǎng zuò chūzūchē.

I would like to take a taxi.

你 在干什么?

Nǐ zài gàn shénme?

What are you doing?

先考驾驶证， 再开车。

Xiān kǎo jiàshǐzhèng, zài kāi chē.

First get a driver’s licence, then drive.

我 六点半 起床。

Wǒ liù diǎn bàn qǐ chuáng.

I get up at 6:30.

Read in meaning groups

六点五十 吃早饭。

Liù diǎn wǔshí chī zǎofàn.

I eat breakfast at 6:50.

七点半 来学校。

Qī diǎn bàn lái xuéxiào.

I come to school at 7:30.

八点四十 上课。

Bā diǎn sìshí shàng kè.

Class starts at 8:40.

十二点 下课。

Shí'èr diǎn xià kè.

Class ends at noon.

十二点一刻 吃午饭。

Shí'èr diǎn yí kè chī wǔfàn.

I eat lunch at 12:15.

Read in meaning groups

下午 我也有课。

Xiàwǔ wǒ yě yǒu kè.

I also have class in the afternoon.

下课后 我 做作业。

Xià kè hòu wǒ zuò zuòyè.

After class, I do homework.

晚上六点 我 坐地铁 回家。

Wǎnshang liù diǎn wǒ zuò dìtiě huí jiā.

At 6 p.m. I take the metro home.

回家后 我 吃晚饭， 复习汉语。

Huí jiā hòu wǒ chī wǎnfàn, fùxí Hànyǔ.

After getting home, I have dinner and review Chinese.

我 大概晚上十一点 睡觉。

Wǒ dàgài wǎnshang shíyī diǎn shuì jiào.

I go to bed at about 11 p.m.

Read in meaning groups

请问， 银行 在哪儿?

Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎr?

Excuse me, where is the bank?

银行 在 书店东边。

Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

The bank is east of the bookshop.

这 是 什么地方?

Zhè shì shénme dìfang?

What place is this?

哪座楼 是 银行?

Nǎ zuò lóu shì yínháng?

Which building is the bank?

宿舍楼 都在 北边。

Sùshè lóu dōu zài běibian.

The dormitory buildings are all in the north.

Read in meaning groups

一号楼、二号楼 在前边， 三号楼、四号楼 在后边。

Yī hào lóu, èr hào lóu zài qiánbian, sān hào lóu, sì hào lóu zài hòubian.

Buildings 1 and 2 are in front; 3 and 4 are behind.

我的宿舍 在 四号楼。

Wǒ de sùshè zài sì hào lóu.

My dorm room is in Building 4.

一直 往前 走。

Yìzhí wǎng qián zǒu.

Go straight ahead.

到路口 往左 转。

Dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ zhuǎn.

At the intersection, turn left.

Related example

书店 在 银行西边。

Shūdiàn zài yínháng xībian.

The bookshop is west of the bank.

Related example

Read in meaning groups

今天 下雨， 我 用雨伞。

Jīntiān xià yǔ, wǒ yòng yǔsǎn.

It is raining today; I use an umbrella.

Related example

我 点了 外卖。

Wǒ diǎn le wàimài.

I ordered food delivery.

Related example

请 找我 十块钱。

Qǐng zhǎo wǒ shí kuài qián.

Please give me ten yuan in change.

Related example

你 很勇敢！

Nǐ hěn yǒnggǎn!

You are brave!

这 是 我们学校。

Zhè shì wǒmen xuéxiào.

This is our school.

Read in meaning groups

东边的 那座楼 是银行。

Dōngbian de nà zuò lóu shì yínháng.

That building on the east side is the bank.

不用。

Bú yòng.

No need.

你 在干嘛?

Nǐ zài gàn má?

What are you doing? (casual)

今天 天气 不好。

Jīntiān tiānqì bù hǎo.

The weather is bad today.

我 不用 出租车。

Wǒ bú yòng chūzūchē.

I do not need a taxi.

Read in meaning groups

我 走路 去学校。

Wǒ zǒu lù qù xuéxiào.

I walk to school.

我 骑电动车 去学校。

Wǒ qí diàndòngchē qù xuéxiào.

I ride an e-bike to school.

我 坐公交车 回家。

Wǒ zuò gōngjiāochē huí jiā.

I take the bus home.

我想 打车， 不想 租车。

Wǒ xiǎng dǎ chē, bù xiǎng zū chē.

I want to get a taxi, not rent a car.

我们 坐高铁 去上海。

Wǒmen zuò gāotiě qù Shànghǎi.

We take the high-speed train to Shanghai.

Read in meaning groups

我 骑自行车 去书店。

Wǒ qí zìxíngchē qù shūdiàn.

I ride a bicycle to the bookshop.

Related example

我 坐出租车 回家。

Wǒ zuò chūzūchē huí jiā.

I take a taxi home.

Related example

我 叫网约车 去学校。

Wǒ jiào wǎngyuēchē qù xuéxiào.

I book an app-based ride to school.

Related example

我 坐火车 去上海。

Wǒ zuò huǒchē qù Shànghǎi.

I take the train to Shanghai.

Related example

我 坐飞机 去上海。

Wǒ zuò fēijī qù Shànghǎi.

I fly to Shanghai.

Related example

Read in meaning groups

我 开车 去学校。

Wǒ kāi chē qù xuéxiào.

I drive to school.

Related example

我 租车 去旅行。

Wǒ zū chē qù lǚxíng.

I rent a car for a trip.

Related example

银行 在 东边。

Yínháng zài dōngbian.

The bank is to the east.

这是 书店， 东边的那座楼 是银行。

Zhè shì shūdiàn, dōngbian de nà zuò lóu shì yínháng.

This is the bookshop; the building east of it is the bank.

谢谢！ 不客气！

Xièxie! Bú kèqi!

Thank you! You’re welcome!

Read in meaning groups

这是 书店， 那是 银行。

Zhè shì shūdiàn, nà shì yínháng.

This is the bookshop; that is the bank.

那座楼 是四号楼， 我的宿舍 在四号楼。

Nà zuò lóu shì sì hào lóu, wǒ de sùshè zài sì hào lóu.

That is Building 4; my dorm room is in Building 4.

书店 在哪儿?

Shūdiàn zài nǎr?

Where is the bookshop?

学校 在 宿舍南边。

Xuéxiào zài sùshè nánbian.

The school is south of the dormitory.

请问， 银行 在哪里?

Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎlǐ?

Excuse me, where is the bank?

Read in meaning groups

外面 下雨了， 带雨伞吧。

Wàimian xià yǔ le, dài yǔsǎn ba.

It is raining outside; take an umbrella.

我 想 点外卖。

Wǒ xiǎng diǎn wàimài.

I want to order food delivery.

我 在找 我的钱。

Wǒ zài zhǎo wǒ de qián.

I am looking for my money.

外面 下雨了， 我 带雨伞。

Wàimian xià yǔ le, wǒ dài yǔsǎn.

It is raining outside; I take an umbrella.

我 有 两千块钱。

Wǒ yǒu liǎng qiān kuài qián.

I have two thousand yuan.

Words & connections

公寓	gōngyù	apartment
卧室	wòshì	bedroom
厨房	chúfáng	kitchen
卫生间	wèishēngjiān	bathroom
客厅	kètīng	living room
房间	fángjiān	room
床	chuáng	bed
桌子	zhuōzi	table; desk
椅子	yǐzi	chair
一套	yí tào	one set; classifier for an apartment
一张	yì zhāng	one flat object; classifier for a bed or desk
两把	liǎng bǎ	two; classifier for chairs or handled objects
租房	zū fáng	rent a home

Words & connections

租车	zū chē	rent a car
出租车	chūzūchē	taxi
坐	zuò	sit; take transport
做	zuò	do; make
座	zuò	classifier for buildings, mountains and bridges
驾驶证	jiàshǐzhèng	driver’s licence
开车	kāi chē	drive a car
起床	qǐ chuáng	get up
早饭	zǎofàn	breakfast
午饭	wǔfàn	lunch
晚饭	wǎnfàn	dinner
上课	shàng kè	attend class
下课	xià kè	finish class

Words & connections

做作业	zuò zuòyè	do homework
坐地铁	zuò dìtiě	take the metro
回家	huí jiā	return home
复习	fùxí	review; revise
睡觉	shuì jiào	sleep; go to bed
大概	dàgài	approximately; before the time expression
左右	zuǒyòu	about; after the time expression
东边	dōngbian	east; eastern side
西边	xībian	west; western side
南边	nánbian	south; southern side
北边	běibian	north; northern side
前边	qiánbian	in front; depends on the viewpoint
后边	hòubian	behind; depends on the viewpoint

Words & connections

左边	zuǒbian	left; depends on which way you face
右边	yòubian	right; depends on which way you face
银行	yínháng	bank
书店	shūdiàn	bookshop
学校	xuéxiào	school
宿舍	sùshè	dormitory
楼	lóu	building; storey
号	hào	number; label for a building
地方	dìfang	place
哪儿	nǎr	where
一座楼	yí zuò lóu	one building
一直	yìzhí	continuously; straight on in a route
往	wǎng	towards; in the direction of

Words & connections

走	zǒu	walk; go on foot
左转	zuǒ zhuǎn	turn left
右转	yòu zhuǎn	turn right
路口	lùkǒu	intersection
下雨	xià yǔ	rain; be raining
雨伞	yǔsǎn	umbrella
外卖	wàimài	takeaway; food delivery
钱	qián	money
千	qiān	thousand
找	zhǎo	look for; give change
用	yòng	use
勇敢	yǒnggǎn	brave
祈祷	qídǎo	pray

Words & connections

走路	zǒu lù	walk; go on foot
骑自行车	qí zìxíngchē	ride a bicycle
骑电动车	qí diàndòngchē	ride an e-bike
坐公交车	zuò gōngjiāochē	take the bus
坐出租车	zuò chūzūchē	take a taxi
叫网约车	jiào wǎngyuēchē	book an app-based ride
坐火车	zuò huǒchē	take the train
坐高铁	zuò gāotiě	take a high-speed train
坐飞机	zuò fēijī	take a plane; fly
打车	dǎ chē	get a taxi / ride-hailing car
打的	dǎ dī	take a taxi (colloquial)
滴滴	Dīdī	DiDi; a ride-hailing app
骑	qí	ride a bicycle or a similar vehicle

Words & connections

开	kāi	drive; open (context matters)
打	dǎ	hail (a taxi); strike (context matters)
叫	jiào	call; order; be called
租	zū	rent; hire
在	zài	be at; located at
再	zài	then; again
哪里	nǎlǐ	where (variant of 哪儿)
两千	liǎng qiān	two thousand
找到	zhǎo dào	find; successfully locate
带	dài	bring; take along
点外卖	diǎn wàimài	order food delivery

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

走路 zǒu lù · walk; go on foot

走路 zǒu lù			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

骑自行车 qí zìxíngchē · ride a bicycle

骑自行车 qí zìxíngchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

骑电动车 qí diàndòngchē · ride an e-bike

骑电动车 qí diàndòngchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

坐公交车 zuò gōngjiāochē · take the bus

坐公交车 zuò gōngjiāochē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

坐出租车 zuò chūzūchē · take a taxi

坐出租车 zuò chūzūchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

叫网约车 jiào wǎngyuēchē · book an app-based ride

叫网约车 jiào wǎngyuēchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

坐高铁 zuò gāotiě · take a high-speed train

坐高铁 zuò gāotiě			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

坐飞机 zuò fēijī · take a plane; fly

坐飞机 zuò fēijī			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

打车 dǎ chē · get a taxi / ride-hailing car

打车 dǎ chē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

租车 zū chē · rent a car

租车 zū chē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

两千 liǎng qiān · two thousand

两千 liǎng qiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

找到 zhǎo dào · find; successfully locate

找到 zhǎo dào			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

公寓 gōngyù · apartment

公寓 gōngyù			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

卧室 wòshì · bedroom

卧室 wòshì			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

厨房 chúfáng · kitchen

厨房 chúfáng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

卫生间 wèishēngjiān · bathroom

卫生间 wèishēngjiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

房间 fángjiān · room

房间 fángjiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

出租车 chūzūchē · taxi

出租车 chūzūchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

租房 zū fáng · rent a home

租房 zū fáng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

驾驶证 jiàshǐzhèng · driver's licence

驾驶证 jiàshǐzhèng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

做作业 zuò zuòyè · do homework

做作业 zuò zuòyè			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

坐地铁 zuò dìtiě · take the metro

坐地铁 zuò dìtiě			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

回家 huí jiā · return home

回家 huí jiā			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

睡觉 shuì jiào · sleep; go to bed

睡觉 shuì jiào			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

东边 dōngbian · east; eastern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
东边 dōngbian			

西边 xībian · west; western side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
西边 xībian			

南边 nánbian · south; southern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
南边 nánbian			

北边 běibian · north; northern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
北边 běibian			

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

前边 qiánbian · in front; depends on the viewpoint

前边 qiánbian			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

后边 hòubian · behind; depends on the viewpoint

后边 hòubian			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

左边 zuǒbian · left; depends on which way you face

左边 zuǒbian			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

右边 yòubian · right; depends on which way you face

右边 yòubian			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

银行 yínháng · bank

银行 yínháng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

书店 shūdiàn · bookshop

书店 shūdiàn			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

学校 xuéxiào · school

学校 xuéxiào			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

宿舍 sùshè · dormitory

宿舍 sùshè			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

一直 yìzhí · continuously; straight on in a route

一直 yìzhí			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

左转 zuǒ zhuǎn · turn left

左转 zuǒ zhuǎn			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

钱 qián · money

钱 qián			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

千 qiān · thousand

千 qiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Try without the model / 1



1. 银行在书店的哪边?
2. 书店在银行的哪边?
3. 一号楼在书店的哪边?
4. 书店在一号楼的哪边?
5. 四号楼在三号楼的哪边?
6. 三号楼在四号楼的哪边?
7. 四号楼在二号楼的哪边?
8. 二号楼在四号楼的哪边?

Try without the model / 2

Use your Chinese keyboard. Type the Pinyin letters without tone marks, then select the intended Hanzi candidate.

1. zuo · 我……地铁。
坐 / 做 / 座

2. zuo · 我……作业。
坐 / 做 / 座

3. zuo · 一……楼。
坐 / 做 / 座

4. qian · 请找我十块……。
钱 / 千 / 前

5. fang · ……间
方 / 房 / **放**

6. shi · 卧……
试 / 室 / **事**

7. ke · 上……
课 / 客 / **可**

8. zhao · 我……书店。
找 / 我 / **戏**

Try without the model / 3

Write the missing system: Hanzi → Pinyin with tones; Pinyin → Hanzi.

东边 _____

银行 _____

厨房 _____

坐地铁 _____

qián _____

qiān _____

xuéxiào _____

yǔsǎn _____

Speak, then check

银行在哪儿？你的宿舍在哪座楼？你几点起床？

Check after your attempt

Where is the building?

1. 东边 dōngbian
2. 西边 xībian
3. 北边 běibian
4. 南边 nánbian
5. 东边 dōngbian
6. 西边 xībian
7. 北边 běibian
8. 南边 nánbian

IME

1 坐 · 2 做 · 3 座 · 4 钱 · 5 房 · 6 室 · 7 课 · 8 找

Hanzi / Pinyin with tones

dōngbian · yínháng · chúfáng · zuò dìtiě

钱 · 千 · 学校 · 雨伞